



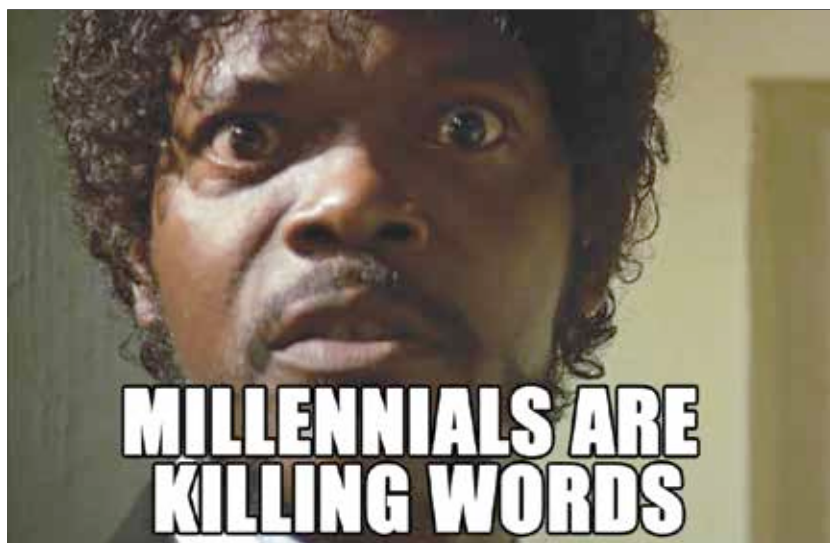
Retiring slows brains down

Research indicates that brain function rapidly declines as soon as people stop working or retire. <http://digit.in/oldnotgold>



97% of turtles since 2002 female

Thanks to global warming, 97 percent of all turtles born since 2002 have been female, with a ratio of 116 females to 1 male. <http://digit.in/alltheturts>



The “news” sites catering to bored millennials, sourcing content from Reddit, are leading the charge when it comes to pulverising the meanings of newfangled words.

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One of our readers posted on Facebook how modern technology has given so many options for

people to express themselves, but people still “type lyk dis”. I responded with a “tl;dr”. I totally typ lyk dat. Its kewl, or like, whatever. I can understand that languages are perpetually evolving. The problem is forcing new meanings on words. Typically, people also don’t care enough to understand the drivel, just look for a chance to respond with their own nonsense. Another opportunity to rant, in search of validation.

When a friend got engaged, someone posted in the group chat, “congrats bro! You also got banged!” None of my friends found that inappropriate. When I pointed out that it was in bad taste, one of my friends told me my “receiving power” was not good.

One of the biggest challenges to my receiving power is the word “meme”.

The word was coined by Richard Dawkins in the book *The Selfish Gene*. Examples given by Dawkins of memes include “tunes, ideas, catch-phrases, clothes fashions, ways of making pots or of building arches.” The Oxford English Dictionary, which is clearly trying to keep up now, includes a definition of the second, more commonly used sense, “an image, video, piece of text, etc., typically humorous in nature, that is copied and spread rapidly by Internet users, often with slight variations.”

All images with text on them are not memes, they are “image macros”. Ya Dun Goofed.

Another frequently misused word, is “troll”. Listicle sites catering to a primarily millennial audience frequently post stories that involve a celebrity doing something stupid, and subsequently getting “trolled” on Twitter. Coming up with puns or joking about an incident is not trolling. One easy way to tell is that a troll is

not personally invested in what he is saying or doing, and the only purpose is to elicit a response. Trolling has a loftier purpose.

Trolling is an art form. Willy on Wheels, who replaced the front page of Wikipedia with a custom logo, Jai Maharaj on Usenet imparting unasked for wisdom on spirituality and food habits, RBX on Yahoo! Answers, who made it a point to provide politically incorrect answers that just might actually work, or Anonymous working together to fix the 2009 Time Magazine Person of the Year poll to read “Marblecake also the game” when the list was read vertically. The real trolls are legendary.

Now coming to the word “millennial”. This is again used frequently by listicle sites who troll their own audience by posting articles on the latest thing that millennials are apparently killing. Movies, relationships, golf, motorcycles, brands... there are probably enough dead things to make a list of. Next time you hear someone use the word “millennial”, ask them for the meaning. They are very likely to say something on the lines of “those born after the year 2,000”. Although not de-



Milhouse is not a meme

defined exactly, “millennial” describes those born from roughly the early 80s to the mid 90s. The word refers to a generation that were young adults at the turn of the century, not those born after. The post millennial generation, those that the actual millenni-

als frequently like to rage about, are referred to as “Generation Z”. The next time you hear someone complaining about millennials, say ranting about how millennials are killing words, feel free to point out that they are actually talking about themselves. That would be terribly ironic.

I am not advocating that the millennials acquire a Tharoorian lexicon here, bt it iz stil posebL 2 typ lyk DIS n uz d rght wrds. 